

Denise J. Roth

Strategic Communication Group • Wageningen University & Research • Wageningen, the Netherlands

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Research interests: politicization of science communication, political communication, computational text analysis, science–society relations, science and race/ethnicity

Education

Oct 2023 – Sept 2027 **Ph.D. Communication Science** *Wageningen, Netherlands*

Wageningen University & Research

Dissertation: “The Politicization of Science Communication”. Supervisors: Dr. Svenja Schäfer, Prof. Dr. Sanne Kruijkemeier, Prof. Dr. Rens Vliegthart.

Sept 2021 – Jun 2023 **M.Sc. Research Master Societal Resilience** *Amsterdam, the Netherlands*

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

GPA: 8.6 (graduated with distinction). Thesis grade: 9.0/10 — nominated for the Johannes van der Zouwen Thesis Prize, Faculty of Social Sciences. Courses: Data Mining & Text Analysis, Social Network Analysis, Dynamics of Interconnectedness and Polarization, Mixed Methods.

Sept 2019 – Feb 2020 **Erasmus+ Exchange — Politics and International Relations** *Sheffield, UK*

The University of Sheffield

Courses: Contemporary International Relations Theory, Political Theory in Practice, The Political Economy of Global Capitalism.

Aug 2017 – Feb 2021 **B.A. Political Science (minor: Media and Communication Studies)** *Mannheim, Germany*

University of Mannheim

Thesis (Political Sociology): “Abortion Attitudes and the Evangelical Vote for Donald Trump in the 2016 Presidential Election”. Courses: The Politics of Free Speech and Censorship, Political Communication and Networks, Empirical Political Research.

Research Experience

Sept – Dec 2025 **Visiting Scholar** *New Brunswick, NJ, USA*
School of Communication and Information, Rutgers University
Host: Dr. Sarah Shugars. Developed a research project on computational analysis of health communication in Black-oriented digital media, examining how health narratives are framed through culturally and historically grounded perspectives on YouTube.

Oct 2023 – Sept 2027 **PhD Candidate** *Wageningen, the Netherlands*

Strategic Communication Group, Wageningen University & Research

Supervisors: Dr. Svenja Schäfer, Prof. Dr. Sanne Kruijkemeier, Prof. Dr. Rens Vliegthart. Dissertation on the politicization of science communication (five papers): (1) agenda-setting dynamics around climate change adaptation; (2) public perceptions of science–politics interactions across 16 European countries; (3) incivility targeting politicians, journalists, and scientists on social media; (4) rhetorical strategies used to cast doubt on scientific evidence; (5) experiment on the effects of political advocacy on the perceived credibility of scientists.

Feb 2023 – Sept 2023	Research Assistant <i>Wageningen University & Research</i> D3-C2 project “Taking climate action in the hustle of policy, politics and (social) media”. Examined dynamic interactions of policy, politics, traditional media, and social media regarding climate change adaptation in the Netherlands and the UK using computational text analysis (newspaper articles, parliamentary debates, Twitter data).	<i>Wageningen, the Netherlands</i>
Aug 2022 – Aug 2023	Student Assistant — R Helpdesk <i>Communication Science Department, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam</i> Supported teaching of courses in advanced statistics and computational text analysis in R; assisted faculty with R-related queries.	<i>Amsterdam, the Netherlands</i>
Aug 2022 – Aug 2023	Student Mentor <i>Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam</i> Mentor for the Research Master program. Organized student events, provided course support, and assisted the program coordinator in teaching “Peer Group Learning”.	<i>Amsterdam, the Netherlands</i>
Aug 2020 – Jul 2021	Student Assistant <i>Mannheim Centre for European Social Research</i> Project on socioeconomic and educational trajectories of German youth with a migration history. Organized and supervised CATIs; conducted literature research on discrimination in the German education system.	<i>Mannheim, Germany</i>
Oct 2018 – May 2019	Student Assistant <i>Mannheim Centre for European Social Research</i> Project on political participation and voting behavior. Organized focus group interviews, created transcripts, applied quantitative content analysis, and combined interview and survey data in a mixed-method design.	<i>Mannheim, Germany</i>

Graduate Training & Workshops

2026	Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS-Penn) <i>University of Pennsylvania</i>	<i>Philadelphia, PA, USA</i>
2026	From Desktop to Cluster: Scaling CSS with High-Performance Computing <i>Pre-conference Workshop, 8th Annual COMPTTEXT Conference</i> Instructor: Andreas Küpfer (TU Darmstadt).	<i>Birmingham, UK</i>
2026	AI-Powered Qualitative Analysis in R <i>Pre-conference Workshop, 8th Annual COMPTTEXT Conference</i> Instructor: Kenneth Benoit (Singapore Management University).	<i>Birmingham, UK</i>
2025	Advanced Methods for Social Network Analysis <i>Fall Seminar in Computational Social Science, GESIS</i> Instructors: Lorien Jasny and Laura Roldán Gómez (University of Exeter).	<i>Mannheim, Germany</i>
2025	Automated Content Analysis of Visual Data <i>Pre-conference Workshop, 7th Annual COMPTTEXT Conference</i> Instructor: Tobias Heidenreich (WZB Berlin Social Science Center).	<i>Vienna, Austria</i>

2025	Expand your Toolkit! Harnessing Diverse Task Types for Concept Measurement <i>Vienna, Austria</i> <i>Pre-conference Workshop, 7th Annual COMPTTEXT Conference</i> Instructor: Hauke Licht (University of Innsbruck).	
2024	From Embeddings to LLMs: Advanced Text Analysis with Python <i>Mannheim, Germany</i> <i>Fall Seminar in Computational Social Science, GESIS</i> Instructors: Hauke Licht and Lisa Lechner (University of Innsbruck).	
2024	Validation in Automated Text Analysis <i>Amsterdam, Netherlands</i> <i>Pre-conference Workshop, 6th Annual COMPTTEXT Conference</i> Instructor: Jana Bernhard (University of Vienna).	
2023	Analyzing Images as Data <i>Glasgow, Scotland</i> <i>Pre-conference Workshop, 5th Annual COMPTTEXT Conference</i> Instructor: Clint Claessen (Salzburg Centre of European Union Studies).	
2023	Text Classification with BERT <i>Glasgow, Scotland</i> <i>Pre-conference Workshop, 5th Annual COMPTTEXT Conference</i> Instructor: Moritz Laurer (Cohere).	

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Articles

2025	Roth, D.J. , Bai, N., Biesbroek, R., Dewulf, A., Kruikemeier, S., de Leur, D., van der Velden, M. A. C. G., de Vries, E., & Vliegthart, R. "Unveiling Climate Adaptation: A Comprehensive Analysis of Agenda-Setting Dynamics in the United Kingdom and the Netherlands." <i>Science Communication</i> , o(o). doi:10.1177/10755470251376576
2025	Schrijver, L., Roth, D.J. , Jans, E., Vrielink, J., & Guldemon, P. "Effective Ways of Casting Doubt? Examining the Different Effects of Blatant and Suggestive Disinformation." <i>International Journal of Communication</i> , 19, 23. ijoc.org
2025	Van der Velden, M. A. C. G., López Ortega, A., Roth, D.J. , & Guldemon, P. "Populism and Polarization: A Nostalgic Narrative of 'Us' and 'Them'." <i>Government & Opposition</i> , 60(4), 1408–1425. doi:10.1017/gov.2025.10020

Working Papers & Under Review

under review	Roth, D.J. , Schäfer, S., Kruikemeier, S., & Vliegthart, R. "Evidence-Informed Policymaking and the Populist Challenge: Public Attitudes Across 16 European Countries."
under review	Schäfer, S., Roth, D.J. , Mede, N., Kruikemeier, S., & Vliegthart, R. "Playing it smart: Can gamification and alarmist framing improve public understanding of zoonotic diseases?"
under review	Van der Velden, M., López Ortega, A., Roth, D.J. , & Guldemon, P. "Do We All Long for the Past? Investigating Nostalgia as a Persuasive Political Rhetorical Strategy."
in progress	Roth, D.J. , De Vries, E., Schäfer, S., Kruikemeier, S., & Vliegthart, R. "Targeted Hostility: Hateful Communication in YouTube Comments Toward Journalists, Politicians, and Scientists."

in progress	Roth, D. J. , Van der Velden, M., & Damstra, A. “The Scientization of Politics: How Politicians Use Science Instrumentally to Depoliticize Conflict.”
in progress	Roth, D. J. , & Shugars, S. “Health Communication in Black-Oriented Media: A Computational Text Analysis of YouTube.”
in progress	Roth, D. J. , Schäfer, S., Kruikemeier, S., & Vliegenthart, R. “Does Policy Advocacy Cost Scientists Their Credibility?.”
in progress	Alva, D., Roth, D. J. , Divya, S., Téliz Martínez, S., & Zhang, Y. “Who’s Asking? Auditing (Social Identity) Bias in Large Language Model Responses to Sexual and Reproductive Health (SRH) Information Seeking.”

Conference Presentations

2026	ECPR General Conference, Jagiellonian University, Kraków, Poland
2026	76th Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA). Cape Town, South Africa.
2026	8th Annual COMPTTEXT Conference. University of Birmingham, Birmingham, UK.
2026	Etmaal van de Communicatiewetenschap. Wageningen University & Research, Arnhem, the Netherlands.
2025	SCOPE Conference. RPTU Landau, Landau (Pfalz), Germany.
2025	Communicating Planetary Health Conference. LMU Munich, Munich, Germany.
2025	75th Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA). Denver, Colorado, US.
2025	7th Annual COMPTTEXT Conference. University of Vienna, Vienna, Austria.
2025	Etmaal van de Communicatiewetenschap. KU Leuven, Bruges, Belgium.
2024	6th Annual COMPTTEXT Conference. Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, Amsterdam, the Netherlands.
2024	Etmaal van de Communicatiewetenschap. Erasmus Universiteit Rotterdam, Rotterdam, the Netherlands.
2023	5th Annual COMPTTEXT Conference. University of Strathclyde, Glasgow, UK.
2023	Etmaal van de Communicatiewetenschap. Universiteit Twente, Enschede, the Netherlands.

Teaching & Supervision

October 2026	Instructor — “Computational Text Analysis for the Social Sciences” <i>Wageningen Graduate School (WASS)</i> Graduate-level course on computational text analysis methods for social science research in Python. Course materials available here .
[Year]	Bachelor Thesis Supervisor <i>Strategic Communication Group, Wageningen University & Research</i> Supervised one thesis on youth engagement with crisis-related news.
2024 – present	Instructor — “Data Types for Health Promotion” <i>M.Sc. Health and Society, Wageningen University & Research</i> Introductory computational text analysis of social media data in Python. Course materials available here .

2024

Workshop Instructor — “Introduction to Computational Text Analysis in R”

5th Annual COMPTExT Conference, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

Introductory workshop on computational text analysis using R. Workshop materials available [here](#).

Awards & Funding

2025

Junior Researcher Grant

Wageningen School of Social Sciences (WASS)

€4,000.

2023

Johannes van der Zouwen Thesis Prize

Faculty of Social Sciences, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

Nominated.

Service to Profession

Editorial

Guest Editor, *Tijdschrift voor Communicatiewetenschap*, Special Issue “Moving Through Communication” (Ertmaal van de Communicatiewetenschap 2026).

Peer Review

New Media & Society; *Global Environmental Politics*; *International Journal of Sustainability in Higher Education*; ICA Annual Conference

Skills & Languages

Languages

English (native), German (native), Dutch (fluent), French (intermediate), Spanish (beginner), Hebrew (beginner)

Statistics

R, Stata, SPSS

Programming

Python

Databases

ElasticSearch

Markup

LaTeX, Markdown, HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Systems

Linux, cloud computing

References

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